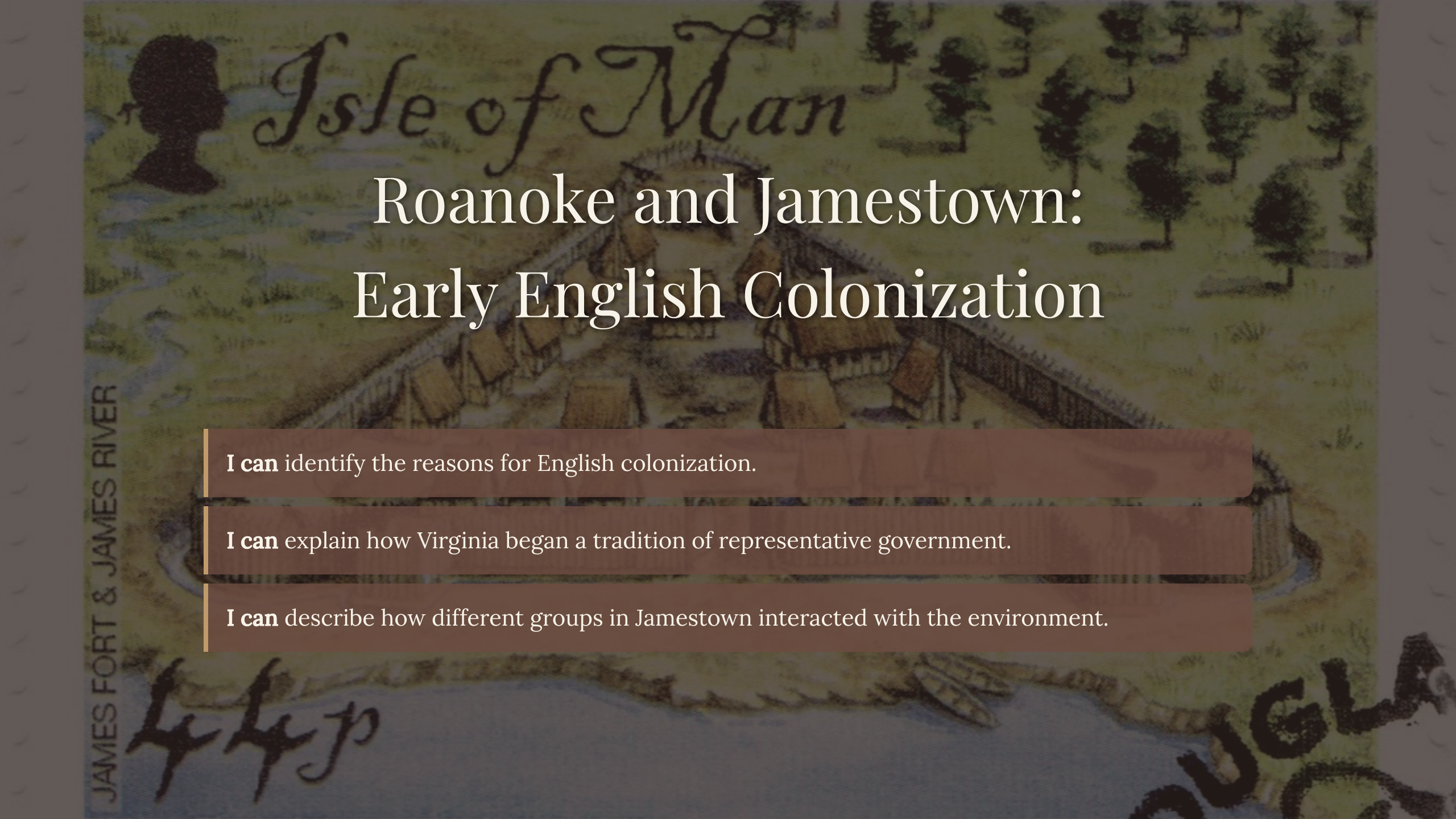




Isle of Man

Roanoke and Jamestown: Early English Colonization

I **can** identify the reasons for English colonization.

I **can** explain how Virginia began a tradition of representative government.

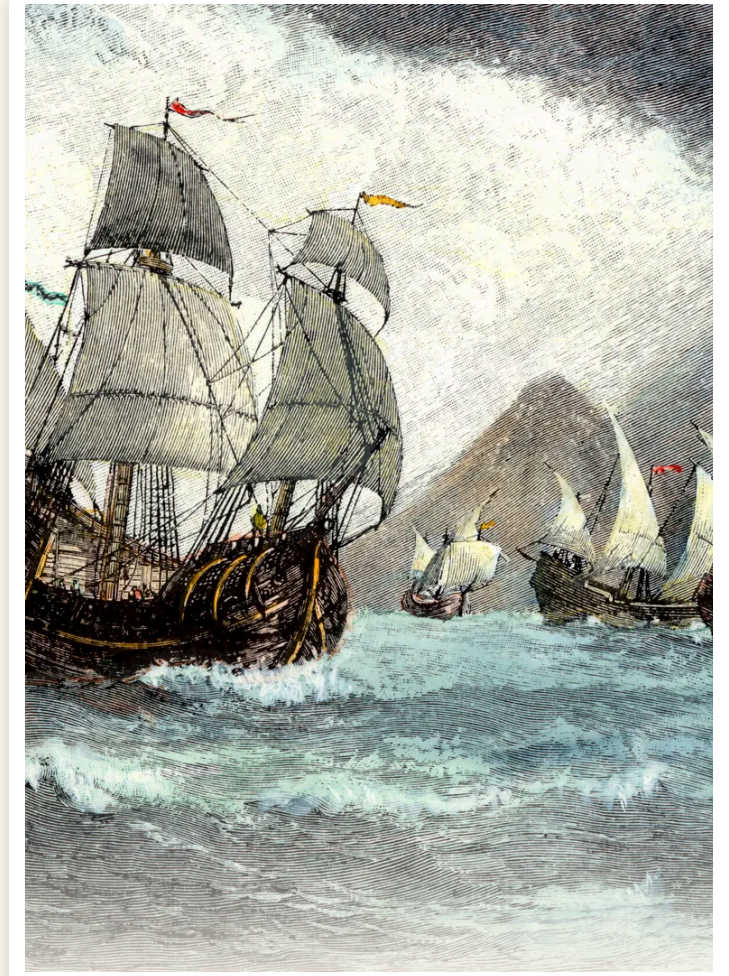
I **can** describe how different groups in Jamestown interacted with the environment.

Learning Objectives

- **I can** identify the reasons for English colonization.
- **I can** explain how Virginia began a tradition of representative government.
- **I can** describe how different groups in Jamestown interacted with the environment.

Reasons for English Colonization

- **Economic:** Seek profits through gold, cash commodities, new markets, and a water route to Asia (Northwest Passage)
- **Political/Strategic:** Claim territory for England and compete with Spain and other European powers gaining riches from colonies
- **Security:** Choose defensible locations to avoid Spanish detection and attack, as Jamestown settlers did despite unhealthy conditions
- **Charter incentive:** Rights of English citizens guaranteed to colonists under company charters, encouraging settlement and investment



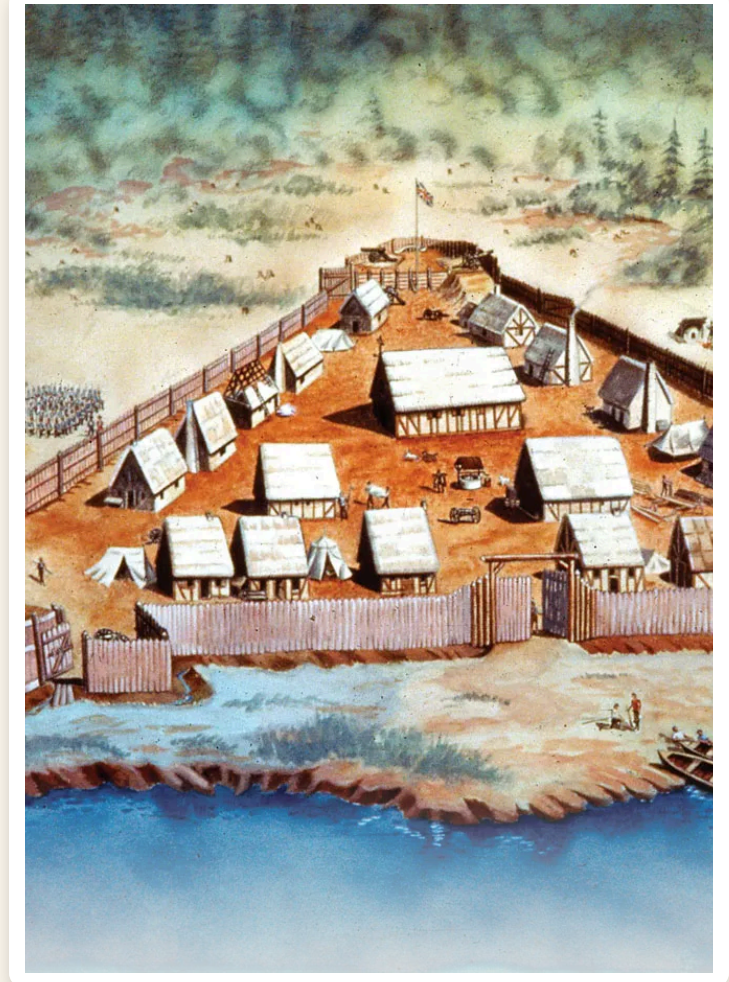
The Lost Colony of Roanoke (1585–1587)

- **1585 First Attempt:** About 100 men landed on Roanoke Island but ran short of food and quarreled with Native Americans. Colonists abandoned the settlement within a year, sailing home with an English ship.
- **1587 Settlement:** John White led a new group of 117 colonists including women and children to Roanoke. When supplies ran low, White returned to England for provisions, leaving the settlers behind.
- **Mystery of CROATOAN:** War with Spain delayed White's return for three years. When he finally returned in 1590, the colony was deserted with only "CROATOAN" carved on a tree—their fate remains unknown to this day.
- **Causes of Failure:** Lack of adequate supplies, strained relations with Native Americans, isolation from England, and delayed resupply due to the Anglo-Spanish War likely contributed to the colony's disappearance.



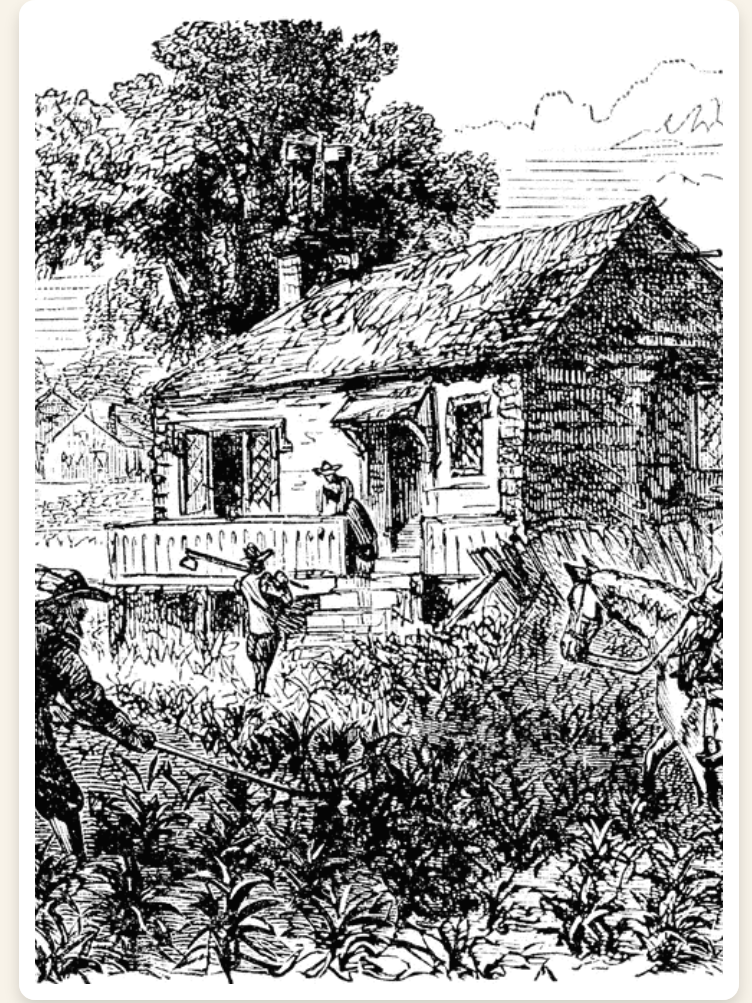
Jamestown Settlement (1607): Founding and Struggles

- **Founded by the Virginia Company:** Established under royal charter from King James I; colonists retained rights of Englishmen
- **Site challenges:** Swampy location along James River chosen for defense against Spanish, but led to unhealthy water conditions and mosquito-borne malaria
- **Early problems:** Poor leadership from quarreling council of 13 men, colonists focused on finding gold rather than producing food, leading to starvation
- **Captain John Smith:** Enforced "work or starve" rules and negotiated with Powhatan for corn supplies, helping the struggling colony survive



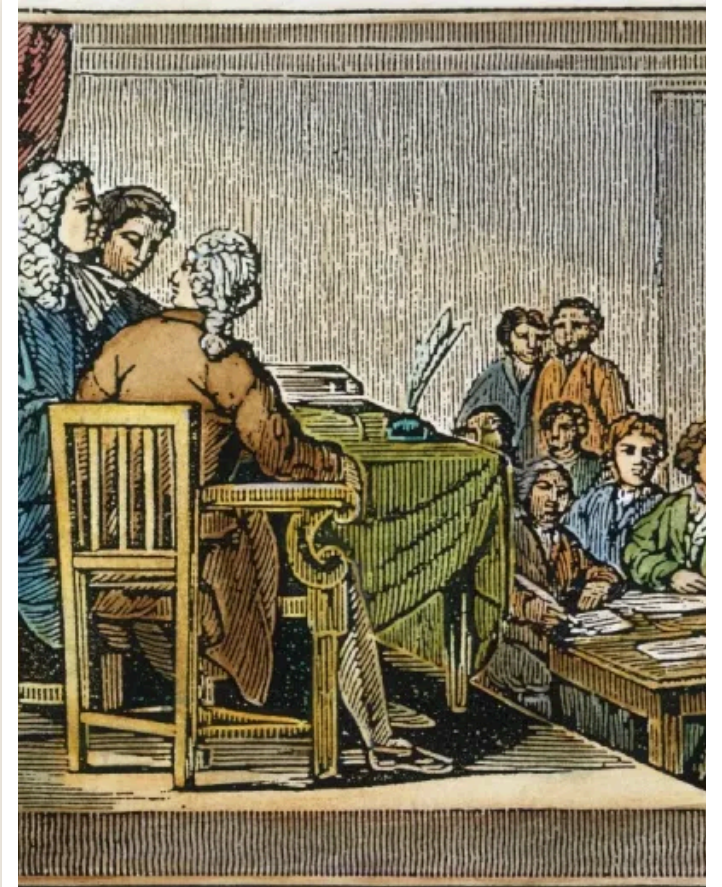
Interactions with the Environment

- **English colonists:** Cleared forests, built forts, and after 1612 planted tobacco, reshaping land and soil for agricultural use
- **Survival learning:** Initially struggled with fishing, hunting, and farming; learned to adapt after the "Starving Time" by better utilizing local resources
- **Powhatan peoples:** Cultivated corn, managed forests, and followed seasonal cycles; traded food knowledge that helped colonists survive
- **Wider context:** Dutch and French fur trade reduced beaver populations in other regions, showing varied environmental impacts of European colonization



Representative Government in Virginia (1619)

- **House of Burgesses:** First elected legislative assembly in English North America, convened July 30, 1619 at Jamestown church
- **Structure:** Governor George Yeardley, his council, and elected burgesses (representatives) from settlements formed the General Assembly
- **Significance:** Established a tradition of representative self-government in Virginia that became a model for later American democracy
- **Foundations:** Virginia Company charter guaranteed colonists the same rights as English citizens, affirming legal traditions and representation



Colonial Assembly in Virginia.

Conclusion & Review

- **Motives:** English sought profits, routes, and power, leading to attempts at Roanoke and a permanent foothold at Jamestown
- **Governance:** The House of Burgesses (1619) began Virginia's tradition of representative government, establishing democratic foundations in North America
- **Environment:** Colonists and Native peoples used the land differently; tobacco transformed Virginia's landscape and economy after 1612
- **Quick Check**
Which motive best explains Jamestown's location choice? How did 1619 change colonial politics? Name two environmental impacts of tobacco farming.